

Pia Molitor | CV

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Profile

Applied microeconomist and doctoral researcher with experience in quantitative policy advice, microsimulation, and causal empirical analysis in labor, family, public, and gender economics. Research Associate at Fraunhofer FIT working on data-driven reform assessments for federal ministries; prior experience at various research institutions and the European Parliament. Strong record of translating complex empirical results into policy-relevant publications, briefings, and presentations.

Education

Institute for Socioeconomics <i>External PhD Student</i>	University of Duisburg-Essen, Germany 2023 - today
Vienna University of Economics and Business <i>M.Sc. Economics</i>	Vienna, Austria 2020 - 2022
Rheinische Friedrich-Wilhelms-Universität <i>B.Sc. Economics</i>	Bonn, Germany 2016 - 2020

2018: Semester abroad, University College Cork, Ireland.

Experience

Fraunhofer Institute for Applied Information Technology <i>Research Associate</i> Microsimulation and Econometric Data Analysis	Sankt Augustin, Germany 2023 - today
European Parliament <i>Schuman-Trainee</i> Economic Governance and EMU Scrutiny Unit	Brussels, Belgium 2022 - 2023
Vienna University of Economics and Business <i>Research Assistant</i> Project: Gendered Economic Relations in Evolution	Vienna, Austria 2021 - 2022
EcoAustria <i>Research Assistant</i>	Vienna, Austria 2021
German Council of Economic Experts <i>Internship</i> Special Report 2020: The Economic Outlook in the Coronavirus Pandemic	Wiesbaden, Germany 2020
Institute of Labor Economics <i>Student Assistant</i>	Bonn, Germany 2017 - 2020

Research Interests

Family Economics, Labor Economics, Public Economics, Applied Microeconometrics

Software

Stata, R, Python, MS Office

Publication

Uncovering the Choreography of Life: The Impact of Life Transitions on Gendered Housework Patterns (with Mara Rebaudo and Miriam Rehm, *Scandinavian Journal of Economics* 2026)

Abstract: This paper investigates gendered changes in time allocated to routine housework chores around four life events (cohabitation, marriage, first birth, and divorce) with the aim of understanding the role of social norms. Using data from the German Socio-Economic Panel for the years 1991 to 2019 we apply a timing-based event-study design which we supplement with a hybrid event study and a heterogeneity-robust estimator. The results show that gender differences intensify during the transitions of cohabitation and especially parenthood (but not with marriage), which we interpret as the effects of social norms. While both men and women increase their housework hours upon entering cohabitation, the effect for men is weaker and short-lived. Women's housework hours increase significantly with childbearing, while men's decrease. After divorce, women reduce, and men significantly increase, their time allocated to housework. Couples with higher-earning women and those in East Germany show weaker adherence to these social roles.

Working Paper

Who Cares? Parental Leave Benefits and Household Division of Childcare (with Federica Meluzzi and Jakob Wegmann, supported by the 2026 Early Career Research Awards of W.E. Upjohn Institute for Employment Research)

Abstract: Low take-up of parental leave by fathers is a key driver of the unequal career costs of parenthood for men and women. Can the design of public policies effectively increase fathers' participation in parental leave? This paper provides causal evidence on how financial incentives shape the intra-household allocation of childcare. We exploit exogenous variation in parental leave benefits induced by a sharp kink in the benefit schedule relative to individual pre-birth net income, combined with novel German administrative data covering millions of households between 2014 and 2018. Using a double Regression Kink Design — an extension of the RKD methodology by Card et al. (2015) — we estimate the behavioral responses of both mothers and fathers to changes in their own and their partner's replacement rates. We find that a reduction in the mother's benefit leads to a substitution in parental inputs, decreasing her leave duration while increasing the father's takeup, especially along the intensive margin, without altering the total duration of parental leave taken by the household. However, responses are quantitatively modest, reflecting persistent traditional gender roles, and are stronger when fathers face lower opportunity costs and in more egalitarian regions. Our findings highlight how financial incentives interact with cultural and economic constraints to shape household decisions, with implications for the design of family policies aimed at fostering gender equality.

Policy Contributions

- *Unterstützung substanzieller Erwerbstätigkeit und partnerschaftlicher Aufgabenteilung durch pauschale finanzielle Anreize - Einzelfallbeispiele und Simulationsrechnungen*, Fraunhofer FIT ([link](#))
- Various Briefings / Analyses at the European Parliament 2022/23 ([link](#))
- *Overtime hours worked: a missing factor in understanding the gender wage gap*, Blog-entry November 2022, Women in Economics Initiative e.V. ([link](#))
- *Nachfrage- und angebotsseitige Einschränkungen der wirtschaftlichen Aktivität in Deutschland infolge der Corona-Pandemie*, Arbeitspapier No. 02/2020, Sachverständigenrat zur Begutachtung der gesamtwirtschaftlichen Entwicklung ([link](#))

- *Selbstständige Erwerbstätigkeit in Deutschland (Aktualisierung 2020)*, IZA Research Report No.93, Institute of Labor Economics ([link](#))

Conferences

2026: EEA (Dublin), VFS (Innsbruck)

2025: 18th RGS Doctoral Conference (Dortmund)

2024: Inequality Conference (Konstanz), Young Economists' Meeting (Brno), IAFPE Conference (Rome), Gender Gaps Conference (Warsaw)

Teaching

2025/2026: Data Visualisation and Analytics (RWTH Aachen, Master's level)

Engagement

- Volunteer in the Research Team of the Women in Economics Initiative e.V., worked on the Women in Economics Index 2020, 2021 and 2022.
- Member of the 14th "Wirtschaftspolitische Akademie" in Vienna (2021/22), seminars and workshops on topics that fall short in Economics studies.